

Riffs & Licks in All 12 Keys

5 Essential Latin Jazz & Tango Patterns — Transposed for Practice

For Alto & Tenor Saxophone

Lick 1: Pentatonic Call

Ascending minor pentatonic burst — use over any minor 7th vamp

C minor



Db minor



D minor



Eb minor



E minor



F minor



F# minor



G minor



2

Ab minor**A minor****Bb minor****B minor**

Lick 2: Smooth Dorian-Spanish ii-V-i

The essential Latin jazz ii-V-i lick. Dorian on ii, Spanish /Jewish on V, resolve to i.

C minor: Dm7 — G7b9 — Cm



Db minor: Ebm7 — Ab7b9 — Dbm



D minor: Em7 — A7b9 — Dm



Eb minor: Fm7 — Bb7b9 — Ebm



E minor: F#m7 — B7b9 — Em



F minor: Gm7 — C7b9 — Fm



F# minor: G#m7 — C#7b9 — F#m



G minor: Am7 — D7b9 — Gm



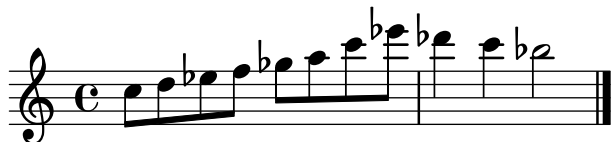
Ab minor: Bbm7 — Eb7b9 — Abm



A minor: Bm7 — E7b9 — Am



Bb minor: Cm7 — F7b9 — Bbm



B minor: C#m7 — F#7b9 — Bm



Lick 3: Spanish Signature Run

Full ascending Spanish/Jewish scale on V7b9, resolving to i. THE Latin dominant sound.

V = G7b9 → Cm



4

V = Ab7b9 → Dbm



V = A7b9 → Dm



V = Bb7b9 → Ebm



V = B7b9 → Em



V = C7b9 → Fm



V = C#7b9 → F#m



V = D7b9 → Gm



V = Eb7b9 → Abm



V = E7b9 → Am



V = F7b9 → Bbm



V = F#7b9 → Bm



Lick 4: Tango Augmented 2nd Cry

Scale degrees 5–b6–7–1–7–b6–5 of harmonic minor. The aug-2nd interval (b6→7) is the tango DNA.

A minor — E F G# A G# F E



Bb minor — F Gb A Bb A Gb F



B minor — F# G A# B A# G F#



C minor — G Ab B C B Ab G



C# minor — G# A B# C# B# A G#



D minor — A Bb C# D C# Bb A



Eb minor — Bb Cb D Eb D Cb Bb

6



E minor — B C D# E D# C B



F minor — C Db E F E Db C



F# minor — C# D E# F# E# D C#



G minor — D Eb F# G F# Eb D



Ab minor — Eb Fb G Ab G Fb Eb



Lick 5: Chromatic Approach into Resolution

Descend from ii through V with chromatic half steps landing on the tonic. Works over any ii-V-i.

→ C (Dm7 — G7 — C)



→ Db



→ D



→ Eb



→ E



→ F



→ F#



→ G



→ Ab



→ A



→ Bb



→ B

